

ترينالي
الشارقة للعمارة
SHARJAH
ARCHITECTURE
TRIENNIAL

**SHARJAH ARCHITECTURE TRIENNIAL
EDITION 1**

SHARJAH VISITORS' GUIDE

RIGHTS OF FUTURE GENERATIONS
(NOV 9, 2019 - FEB 8, 2020)

<https://www.sharjaharchitecture.org>



ABOUT SHARJAH

Uniquely situated on both the Gulf and Indian Ocean coasts, the Emirate of Sharjah—one of the seven that constitute the United Arab Emirates—is at the crossroads of millennia of exchange and mobility, thereby offering an ideal place for conversations about architecture and urbanism.

Archaeological sites and the artifacts displayed at local museums reveal intimate links between inhabitants of the various settlements that flourished in Sharjah and contemporaneous civilizations, from the Mediterranean to the West, Mesopotamia to the north, and the Indus Valley to the east.

This long history as a node for transnational networks has permitted twentieth-century Sharjah to evolve into one of the most vibrant cities in the region, and a multiethnic trading port following the formation of the UAE in 1971. Home to the first international airport in the country, operational since the 1932, and the first container port, constructed in 1976, Sharjah has been a crucial center for connections across the entire coast of the Gulf, as well as India and Africa, and beyond.

Sharjah also shares borders with all other emirates in the UAE. Its built environment is marked by not only the habitable scale of its streets, and an urban landscape where past and present coexist, but also, by ongoing exchanges with other emirates, Gulf countries, and the wider region to which it is fundamentally linked.

Sharjah is home to a diverse population with a strong Arab representation, and is embraced by its local and expatriate inhabitants alike. Architecturally, Sharjah reflects the diversity of its inhabitants as well as the vision of its leadership. Restored vernacular coral stone buildings with courtyards harken back to historical fishing and pearling societies. Expanding modern planned suburban neighborhoods for Emiratis extend to the multi-story urban center that houses expatriate Arab and South Asian families. And neo-Islamic government and educational buildings reflect local pride in regional heritage. Sharjah's architecture is a unique amalgam that distinguishes it from other cities across the region.

This rich legacy of cultural encounters is further highlighted by Sharjah's numerous cultural initiatives. Since its inception in 1993, the Sharjah Biennial has grown into one of the most influential global art institutions, Sharjah Art Foundation. The annual Sharjah International Book Fair, launched in 1982, attracts scholars and publishers from around the world. Additionally, Sharjah has been named the Arab Capital of Culture as well as the Capital of Islamic Culture in recognition of its pioneering cultural patronage, led by His Highness Sheikh Dr Sultan Mohammed Al Qasimi, member of the Federal Supreme Council and Ruler of Sharjah since 1972.

The Triennial complements these diverse initiatives, focusing the conversation on the critical role that architecture and urbanism can play in the present and future of a welcoming and livable Sharjah.



SHARJAH HISTORY

Evidence of Sharjah's history is visible in the cities and maps with archaeological evidence of human civilisation reaching back at least 10,000 years. Excavations in the Mleiha area of Sharjah indicate that humans were already living in the area during the Neolithic Period, the Bronze Age and particularly the Iron Age (1200-400 BCE).

Almost 600 years later, the Greek geographer Ptolemy included Sarcoa (Sharjah) on one of his maps, demonstrating international recognition of the Sharjah area. References to Sharjah can be found on a 1666 Dutch map, which accurately indicates the locations of Sharjah towns Calba (Kalba), Gorfocaa (Khorfakkan) and Dabba (Dibba), and an 1820 British Royal Navy map of the walled city of 'Shargah'.

Sharjah's strategic location and rich natural resources have been major factors in the emirate's economic development. From the sixteenth to nineteenth centuries, European powers such as Portugal, Holland and Britain became interested in Sharjah as they vied to control trade routes between the Mediterranean Sea and India. In addition to the general trading activities, fishing and pearling played an important role in the early economy, but the pearling industry fell victim to strong competition from Japanese cultured pearls in the 1940s and lost its prominence.



SHARJAH ARCHITECTURE TRIENNIAL

WELCOME TO SHARJAH!

Please see below for some useful information you might need before and during your visit.

GENERAL DO'S AND DON'TS

- Sharjah is a fairly conservative emirate. Non-revealing clothing for both men and women, with shoulders and knees covered, is recommended.
- There is a very strict drug policy in the UAE. Recreational drugs are prohibited.
- The Emirate of Sharjah is a dry emirate. Alcohol is prohibited. Visitors who wish to drink can go to hotels in Ajman or Dubai. It is advisable to go by taxi or have a designated driver. Penalties for drunk driving are severe.
- Bottled water is recommended. Tap water is desalinated and can be safe, but it is not usually recommended as drinking water.

UAE CURRENCY

The monetary unit is the Arab Emirate Dirham (AED), or more simply the dirham, which is divided into 100 fils. The dirham is freely convertible, making exchange of travellers cheques and currency easy. The local currency index is linked to the US dollar (1 USD= AED 3.67). The best rate of exchange is usually found in licensed exchange offices although banks and hotels also offer this service.

We recommend the Al Ansari Exchange on Al Arouba Street (+971 6 562 8778)

Offices are generally open on weekdays 8:00 am–10:30 pm. On Friday, most offices are open 2:00 pm–10:00 pm, but some may be open 9:00 am - 11:30 pm.

AIRPORTS

Visitors to Sharjah are served by two airports, both about 20-30 mins from Sharjah Architecture Triennial recommended hotels.

- 1.Sharjah International Airport sharjahairport.ae
- 2.Dubai International Airport dubaiairports.ae

TRAVEL & TOURISM

Skyline Travel

Um Al Tarafa Area Arouba Street +971 6 563 6923 skylineuae.com
Al Faisal Travel, Tourism & Cargo Agency L.L.C.
Al Mureijah Street

(aka Al Meena Road) +971 6 5683333 aftta.com
Sharjah Boat Tours

Al Faisal Travel, Tourism & Cargo Agency L.L.C.

Al Mureijah Street (aka AL Meena Road)
+971 6 5683333aftta.com

City Sightseeing Sharjah

Block D, Entrance 2
(first floor), Al Qasba
+971 6 525 5200
citysightseeingsharjah.ae

WEATHER

Temperatures from November to February range from 16.4°C (61.5°F) at night to 34°C (92.2°F) in the daytime. Light clothes and a hat are recommended during the day while a second layer might be needed as it gets cooler in the evenings and in air conditioned spaces.

ATM MACHINES

ATM machines can be found in the airport as well as at various banks in Sharjah (on Bank Street, in Atlas Mall across the street from the Swiss-Belhotel Sharjah and next to the Corniche Post Office). All ATM locations are a five- to ten-minute walk from SAT offices.

TELEPHONES

1. To call a UAE number from outside the country, use the country code (+971), the code for the individual emirate or mobile phone and then the local phone number. Please note that if a call is made inside the UAE, it is necessary to add a zero before the code for the emirate or mobile phone. Mobile phone codes vary and the most common codes are (0)50, (0)55 and (0)56.

SIM CARDS

2. If you want to get a local SIM card, we recommend obtaining it at the airports (right before you exit). Etisalat business offices and some hotels as well as WH Smith, Jumbo and Emax stores in the local malls.

- You have the option of two primary telecom providers in the UAE: du.ae & etisalat.ae
- The initial cost of the du Visitor Mobile Line is about AED 50 and includes 20 minutes of calls and 200 MB of data, all prepaid for seven days.

SHARJAH HOTELS

1.Radisson Blu Resort

Corniche Street, P.O. Box 3527, Sharjah +971 6 565 7777
radissonblu.com

2.Swiss-Belhotel Sharjah

Al Arouba Street, P.O. Box 5734, Sharjah +971 6 563 7777
swiss-belhotel.com

3.Hilton Sharjah

Corniche Street, Al Majaz 3, Sharjah +971 6 519 2222
www3.hilton.com

4.Copthorne Hotel Sharjah

Corniche Street, Al Majaz 3, P.O. Box 39887, Sharjah +971 6 593 0555
millenniumhotels.com

5.Sheraton Sharjah Beach Resort and Spa

Al Muntazah Street, Sharjah +971 6 563 0000 sheratonsharjah.com

LOCAL TRANSPORT

1.Taxis

Taxis operating in Sharjah are metered and the minimum fare for a trip in a Sharjah taxi is AED 13.50. For trips within Sharjah, the cost ranges from AED 11.50 to AED 30. Visitors should expect to pay AED 70-100 (with an additional AED 20 surcharge added) to travel to Dubai and around AED 300 to go to Abu Dhabi.

2. Careem

Visitors should note that there is heavy traffic going from Sharjah to Dubai between 6:00 and 10:00 am and from Dubai to Sharjah between 4:00 and 8:00 pm.

A smart taxi service called Careem (careem.com) also operates in Sharjah. Accessed through a free smart phone app, the service determines the location of the prospective passenger and sends a car. Careem accepts both cash and credit cards.

Taxi companies with telephone numbers are listed below. For on-line booking for Sharjah government taxis, visit srta.gov.ae.

1.Sharjah Taxi

+971 6 535 6111
Toll free number: 600 52 52 52

2.Emirates Cab

+971 6 539 6666

3.Citi Taxi

+971 6 533 3550

4.Union Taxi

+971 6 532 5555

CAR HIRE

Visitors with a valid driving license from any of the following countries are permitted to drive a private or hired vehicle in the UAE: Australia, Austria, Belgium, Canada, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Holland, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Luxembourg, New Zealand, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Singapore, Slovakia, South Africa, South Korea, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, UK and US. All other visitors must hold an International Driving Permit (IDP) issued by their home country. GCC nationals may drive on their respective licenses within the UAE. For more information about driving licences, see sharjah.ae.

Visitors on a visit visa can also obtain a Temporary Driving License, which is issued at the Sharjah Traffic & Licensing Department, Al Ramtha (+971 6 538 1111) at a cost of AED 80. The license is valid for one month and renewable for a further month at a cost of AED 30.

You can rent a car from the airport in Dubai or Sharjah also has a number of local and international agencies. The minimum age for car rental is 21. To hire a car, visitors must produce their passport, two photos and a national or international driving licence. The hire rate per day for smaller vehicles, including insurance, starts at AED 80, but prices vary.

1. Autolease Rent A Car

Sharjah International Airport and DHL Building,
King Faisal Street, Al Majaz 1 (near Spinneys supermarket) +971 6 573 5333
autolease-uae.com

2. Fast Rent A Car

Sharjah International Airport and Al Wahda Street +971 6 533 8877
fastuae.com

3. Hertz

Sharjah International Airport and Al Wahda Street +971 6 552 8290
+971 6 553 0964
hertz.ae

8. Maximum

Sharjah International Airport, Radisson Blu Resort and Al Khan Street
+971 6 550 1515
+971 6 556 0601
maximumcarrentals.com

EMERGENCY NUMBERS

Police: 999
Ambulance: 998

HOSPITALS

1. Al Zahra Hospital

Clock Tower Roundabout +971 6 561 9999 alzahra.com

2. Zulekha Hospital

Al Zahra Street
+971 6 506 0000 zulekhahospitals.com

3. Central Private Hospital

Sheikh Zayed Street, Mysaloon area +971 6 516 9221 centralprivatehospital.ae

PHARMACIES

1. Millennium Pharmacy

Arouba Street, north side of Al Mureijah area +971 6 568 9416

2. Lamia Pharmacy

Behind Al Corniche Post Office, Al Shuwaiheen area Next to Bait Al Bahar Trading
+971 6 568 0781

MOSQUES

1. Al Daleel Mosque

Built in 1919, one of the oldest mosques in Sharjah Across from the Collections Building, Arts Square Next to Sharjah Art Museum
Ladies section available

2. Al Maghfirah Mosque

Corniche Street, Al Seef area. Next to Radisson Blu Resort Ladies section available

3. Al Noor Mosque

Near Khalid Lagoon, Majaz 1 area. On Al Buhairah Corniche Ladies section available

4. King Faisal Mosque

Largest mosque in Sharjah
King Faisal Street, Al Soor area. Between Sharjah Central Post Office and Central Souq
Ladies section available

BEACHES

Public beaches in Sharjah are located across the city of Sharjah. Please note that Sharjah is a conservative emirate, and the dress code (i.e. shoulders and knees covered) applies in all public areas. In beach areas that are privately owned or operated, standard swimwear is acceptable.

Public beaches

The area from Al Khan Lagoon to Al Mamzar Lagoon, situated on the border between Dubai and Sharjah, is an active location for motorised water sports.

1. Al Corniche Beach is a peaceful beach area with palm trees stretching from the Sharjah Ladies Club to the Coral Beach Resort.

2. Al Khan Beach, located in the historic Al Khan area close to the Sharjah Aquarium, offers both beach sports activities and areas for sunbathing. Managed by G20, the 600-metre beach area can be booked for private and corporate events.

Private beaches in hotels and clubs (fees charged)

1. Kempinski Ajman

Weekdays: Children (under age 12) AED 50, Adults (12+ years) AED 150. Weekends and public holidays: Children (under age 12) AED 75, Adults (12+ years) AED 200

Prices include pool access.

+971 6 714 5555

kempinski.com

2. Coral Beach Resort Sharjah

Weekdays: AED 75. Weekends and public holidays: AED 150 + 971 6 522 9999

hmhhotelgroup.com

3. Radisson Blu Resort Bay Club

Weekdays: Children (under 5 years) free, Children (5-16 years) AED 60, Adults (12+ years) AED 100. Weekends and public holidays: Children (under 5 years) free, Children (5-16 years) AED 75, Adults (12+ years) AED 150

+971 6 565 7777 radissonblu.com

USEFUL SERVICES

Al Jubail Mobile Phone Trading

This shop repairs mobile phones.

Al Mureijah Street (aka Al Meena Road) Opening times: 8:30 am – 11:30 pm +971 52 734 7738

Al Mutanabbi Bookstore

This store has a good range of books, art supplies and stationery. Off Al Mureijah Street, behind old Sharjah cinema, Al Mureijah area +971 6 568 3499

Dar Al Hayat Bookstore

This store sells art supplies and stationery. Near Sharjah Central Post Office
+971 6 572 3736

New Century Computer LLC

This organisation works with both companies and individuals. They sell hardware and software and offer services such as computer repair and data recovery.

Al Mureijah Street (aka Al Meena Road)

Opening times: 9:00 am – 2:00 pm, 5:00 pm – 9:00 pm +971 6 569 3939

newcenturycomputers.com

Tanya Typing & Photocopy Centre

This company photocopies documents and provides typing services for legal documents.

Al Arouba Street near Rolla Square
+971 6 561 3021

Al Shuwaiheen Area -

Sharjah Art Foundation buildings, Arts Square

Saturday – Thursday: 9:00 am – 9:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 pm – 9:00 pm
+971 6 568 5050

sharjahart.org

Sharjah Art Foundation buildings [Al Mureijah]

Close to the intersection between Al Mureijah Street and Corniche Street

Saturday – Thursday: 9:00 am – 9:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 pm – 9:00 pm

+971 6 568 5050

sharjahart.org

Bait Al Shamsi

Located across from the Sharjah Art Museum, Bait Al Shamsi is a historic creekside house built around 1845 and partially restored in 1997. With excellent views of the neighbourhood and the nearby creek, the house has been used for artist studios and residency spaces as well as Sharjah Art Foundation exhibitions, the Sharjah Biennial and other public and private events.

Bait Al Serkal

A three-storey house built in the nineteenth century, Bait Al Serkal was once the residence of the British Commissioner for the Arabian Gulf and members of the ruling Al Qasimi family. In the early 1960s, the house was transformed into the first hospital in Sharjah, where many prominent residents of the city were born. The house was restored in the early 1990s and is now used for Sharjah Art Foundation exhibitions, the Sharjah Biennial and other public and private events.

Sharjah Art Museum

Sharjah Art Museum, one of the main landmarks in Arts Square, was inaugurated during Sharjah Biennial 3 in April 1997. Housing both permanent collections and temporary exhibitions, the museum presents works by international and Arab artists who have explored the history and culture of the region. Artists with works in the permanent collection include Abdulqader Al Rais, Louay Kayali, Bashir Sinwar, Faiq Hassan, Mohammed Yusuf and Ismail Fatah Al Turk.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 8:00 pm Admission free

+971 6 568 8222 sharjahmuseums.ae

Emirates Fine Arts Society

Established as a non-profit organisation in 1980, the Emirates Fine Arts Society has been instrumental in nurturing Emirati artists, representing artists at local and international art events and providing media support. The Society, which is located next to the Sharjah Art Foundation offices, also promotes art education and art appreciation with a focus on Emirati artists. In addition, the Society organises courses and produces a range of fine arts publications.

Saturday: 9:00 am – 9:00 pm, Sunday – Thursday: 9:00 am – 1:00 pm, 5:00 pm – 9:00 pm. Closed on Friday

+971 6 568 4488 artsuae.ae

Collections Building

The Collections Building used to house the Orientalist painting collection of His Highness Sheikh Dr Sultan Al Qasimi, part of which has now been moved to the second floor of the Sharjah Art Museum on Arts Square. Currently, the Collections Building is used mostly for SAF workshops and events, but some exhibitions are held there as well.

Sharjah Art Institute

The Sharjah Art Institute, located between the Collections Building and Bait Al Serkal, offers specialised courses in drawing, painting, sculpture, ceramics, graphics and the history of art.

+971 6 568 8800 heartofsharjah.ae

Sharjah Al Hisn Museum

Located on Bank Street (also called Al Hisn Street) on the dividing line between Al Shuwaiheen and Al Mureijah, the Sharjah Al Hisn Museum is housed in an 1823 fort that has served as the seat of Sharjah government, the residence of the ruling Al Qasimi family, a jail and now a heritage museum. Visitors can see a variety of historic photographs and objects such as traditional weapons that offer insight into Sharjah's daily life and governance over the last two centuries.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 8:00 pm Admission fees: Children (2-12 years) AED 5, Adults (13+ years) AED 10

+971 6 568 5500
sharjahmuseums.ae

Sharjah Calligraphy Museum

Located in the historic house of Hamad Al Midfaa, the Sharjah Calligraphy Museum is the only museum in the Arab world devoted entirely to calligraphy. The museum, located in Calligraphy Square, features works by local artists and well-known international calligraphers. The mission of the museum is to inspire an appreciation for Arabic calligraphy and preserve the cultural heritage.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 8:00 pm Admission fees: Children (2-12 years) AED 5, Adults (13+ years) AED 10 +971 6 569 4561
sharjahmuseums.ae

Sharjah Heritage Museum

Opened originally in 2003 and expanded for a 2012 reopening, the Sharjah Heritage Museum consists of six galleries covering the landscape, lifestyle, celebrations, livelihoods, traditional knowledge and oral traditions of Sharjah.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 8:00 pm Admission fees: Children (2-12 years) AED 5, Adults (13+ years) AED 10 +971 6 568 0006
sharjahmuseums.ae

Sharjah National Theatre

In Sharjah, theatre is valued as one of the most important contributors to the development of culture and public opinion. The Sharjah National Theatre was established in 1975 under the patronage of HH Sheikh Dr Sultan bin Mohammed Al Qasimi to produce meaningful plays and further the development of theatre in Sharjah. The Sharjah National Theatre hosts theatrical, cultural and intellectual forums as well as a number of lectures, seminars and workshops. It has also participated in theatre festivals in the UAE and internationally.

+971 6 568 6600 heartofsharjah.ae

Sharjah Institute of Theatrical Arts

Home of two state-of-the-art proscenium theatres, one that seats 209 and one accommodating 266, the Sharjah Institute of Theatrical Arts promotes the culture of theatre in Sharjah by providing a stage for theatre, drama training, theatrical workshops and academic studies. The institute also hosts conferences and school productions.

+971 6 568 1333 heartofsharjah.ae

Emirates Handcraft Centre

Under the supervision of the Sharjah Institute of Heritage, the Emirates Handcraft Centre includes informational displays about local architecture and food and handcrafts related to the date palm. Of great interest is the traditional house that hosts the Emirates Handcraft Centre, which is called Bait Al Mazroo'a. Located on the edge of Al Mureijah next to the Corniche, the house has 17 rooms built around a courtyard.

+971 6 509 2666 sharjah-heritage.ae

Sharjah City Walls

The remaining sections of the Sharjah city wall, which dates from the 16th century, enclose the side of Al Mureijah furthest away from the Corniche. The wall, like the traditional houses, was built from coral and gypsum.

Sharjah Museum of Islamic Civilisation [Al Majarrah]

Arranged across seven spacious galleries and display areas, the Sharjah Museum of Islamic Civilisation houses more than five thousand artefacts related to science, coinage, maps and art from around the Islamic world. The museum opened in a renovated house in the Heritage Area in 1996 and then moved in 2008 to its current home in a converted Middle Eastern souq on the Corniche, a short distance from the Sharjah Art Museum.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 pm – 8:00 pm Admission fees: Children (2-12 years) AED 5, Adults (13+ years) AED 10 +971 6 565 5455
islamicmuseum.ae

Al Mahatta Museum [Al Manakh]

This museum is dedicated to aviation history, with a particular focus on the UAE. Named after the first airport in the Gulf region, the museum explores flight development and aviation history from the 1930s to the present. One of the main attractions is the collection of fully restored propeller planes and the original refuelling tanker used at the Sharjah airport.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 8:00 pm Admission fees: Children (2-12 years) AED 5, Adults (13+ years) AED 10 +971 6 573 3079
sharjahmuseums.ae

Khalid Lagoon [Al Majaz]

Khalid Lagoon, also known by its Arabic name Al Buhairah, is located on the site of one of the earliest known Arabian Gulf settlements, and some of its current residents can trace their ancestry to that early period. Now an artificial lagoon spread over 1,720,000 square hectares of water surface, it is always a favourite place for evening strolls, family picnics, abra boat trips and Sharjah Fountain light and music shows. Also located in the Khalid Lagoon area are Al Montazah Amusement and Water Park, Al Majaz Amphitheatre and Flag Island, which has the seventh tallest flagpole in the world, design spaces and a restaurant.

Al Majaz Waterfront [Between Al Majaz]

Located on the Khalid Lagoon close to the Sharjah Fountain, Al Majaz Waterfront features a lakefront garden, jogging path, children's playground, train and boat rides and miniature golf as well as a mosque and restaurants. On display in the Maraya Art Park is Wafaa Bilal's The Hierarchy of Being, a domed sculpture designed to recreate the camera obscura effect.

+971 6 552 1552 almajaz.ae

Al Noor Island [Al Majaz 1]

Covering 45,470 square metres, Noor Island merges art and nature to create a quiet sanctuary in the middle of Sharjah. Included in the artworks are the OVO, Torus and Edgar Tezak sculptures and light paintings, all joined together by a 3,500-metre walkway bordered by light installations and gardens containing plants from around the world. The island is also home to a Butterfly House and Literature Pavilion.

Saturday – Wednesday: 9:00 am – 11:00 pm

Thursday – Friday: 9:00 am – midnight

Admission fees: Children (under 3 years) free,

Children (3-11 years) AED 30, Adults (12+ years) AED 50 +971 6 506 7000

alnoorisland.ae

Sharjah Centre for Cultural Communication (SCCC) and Al Noor Mosque [Al Majaz 1]

The best known of Sharjah's over 600 mosques is Al Noor Mosque. Located next to the Khalid Lagoon on the Buhairah Corniche, Al Noor Mosque is an example of traditional Islamic architecture. Completed in 2005, the mosque features an intricate framework, sweeping curves and soaring spires. Under the auspices of the Sharjah Centre for Cultural Communication, Al Noor Mosque is the first mosque in Sharjah to open its doors to the expatriate community and Sharjah visitors so that they may learn about the UAE national culture and religion. Visitors can join a special one-hour tour of Al Noor Mosque every Monday at 10:00 am. Registration is required. Private visits can also be arranged upon request.

SCCC office in Souq Al Arsah open on Sunday, Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday: 8:00 am – 2:00 pm

+971 6 568 0055

shjculture.com

Al Qasba [Al Khan]

A centre for art, tourist and business activities, Al Qasba is located along a one-kilometre-long manmade canal and features pedestrian bridges, a 250-seat theatre, a 60-metre-high Ferris wheel and the Maraya Art Centre, a three-storey creative space with exhibition areas, multimedia facilities, a video archive and library. The Barjeel Art Foundation is also located in the Maraya building. Visitors to Al Qasba can find restaurants serving local and international food, boats for hire and activities for children.

+971 6 525 2444 alqasba.ae

Sharjah Maritime Museum [Al Khan]

The Maritime Museum features information about the role of the sea in the development of Sharjah life from 6,000 years ago until modern times. Special exhibits focus on wooden seafaring dhows and pearling and fishing in the Gulf. Ships, pearls and tools used for seafaring activities are displayed.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 10:00 pm

Admission fees: Children (2-12 years) AED 5, Adults (13+ years)

AED 10 +971 6 522 2002

sharjahmuseums.ae

Sharjah Aquarium [Al Khan]

The Sharjah Aquarium, a marine nature reserve, has an impressive display of more than 150 species, including small fish, rare eels and reef sharks. The aquarium aims to increase awareness of the importance of the marine environment and the means to protect it.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 10:00 pm
Closed on Sundays

Admission fees (a joint ticket with the Maritime Museum): Children (under 2 years) free, Children (2-12) AED 15, Adults (13+ years) AED 25 +971 6 528 5288 sharjahmuseums.ae

Sharjah Archaeology Museum [Halwan/Al Abar]

The Sharjah Archaeology Museum houses collections of artefacts that bear witness to human habitation in Sharjah from the Stone Age until the rise of Islam. Significant pieces in the collection are an ivory comb inside an alabaster bowl (2200-2000 BCE), a ceramic dome and camel statue (900-600 BCE) and a golden bridle (150 BCE-200 CE). The museum has also exhibited artefacts from Petra in Jordan.

Saturday – Thursday: 8:00 am – 8:00 pm, Friday: 4:00 – 8:00 pm
Admission fees: Children (2-12 years) AED 5, Adults (13+ years) AED 10 +971 6 566 5466
sharjahmuseums.ae

University City

Established in 1997 by His Highness Sheikh Dr Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, member of the Federal Supreme Council and Ruler of Sharjah, University City is home to more than 10 educational institutions and over 22,000 students. Covering 11 square kilometres and situated along a wide landscaped boulevard, the various university buildings feature a range of architectural styles, including ornate entrance gates and great domed libraries and classroom buildings.

Dr Sultan Al Qasimi Centre for Gulf Studies* [University City]

Dr Sultan Al Qasimi Centre for Gulf Studies provides researchers with integrated and comprehensive historical and geographical research materials that trace the development, history and heritage of life in the Arabian Gulf. The centre exhibits artefacts and publications from the private collection of His Highness Sheikh Dr Sultan Al Qassimi.

Included are original and historical collectors' maps, the first images of the region and rare coins with special relevance to the Gulf as well as His Highness's published works, degrees, awards and documentation of his early life. In addition to His Highness's private collection, the centre houses a library and archive with more than one and a half million historical documents, maps and records, some of which are rare.

Sunday – Thursday: 9:00 am – 4:00 pm
Closed on Friday and Saturday

Free admission +971 6 558 5855 dsqc.ae

* The Centre is relocating to the opposite end of University City. Some exhibits may be closed.

ARCHEOLOGICAL SITES

Archaeological sites bearing witness to ancient civilisations in Sharjah can be found all across the emirate. Only some are regularly open to the public; others can be visited by appointment only. Three examples are presented below. Information about the others can be found on the website of the Sharjah Archaeology Authority, which is located within the Sharjah Archaeology Museum in the Halwan area of the city.

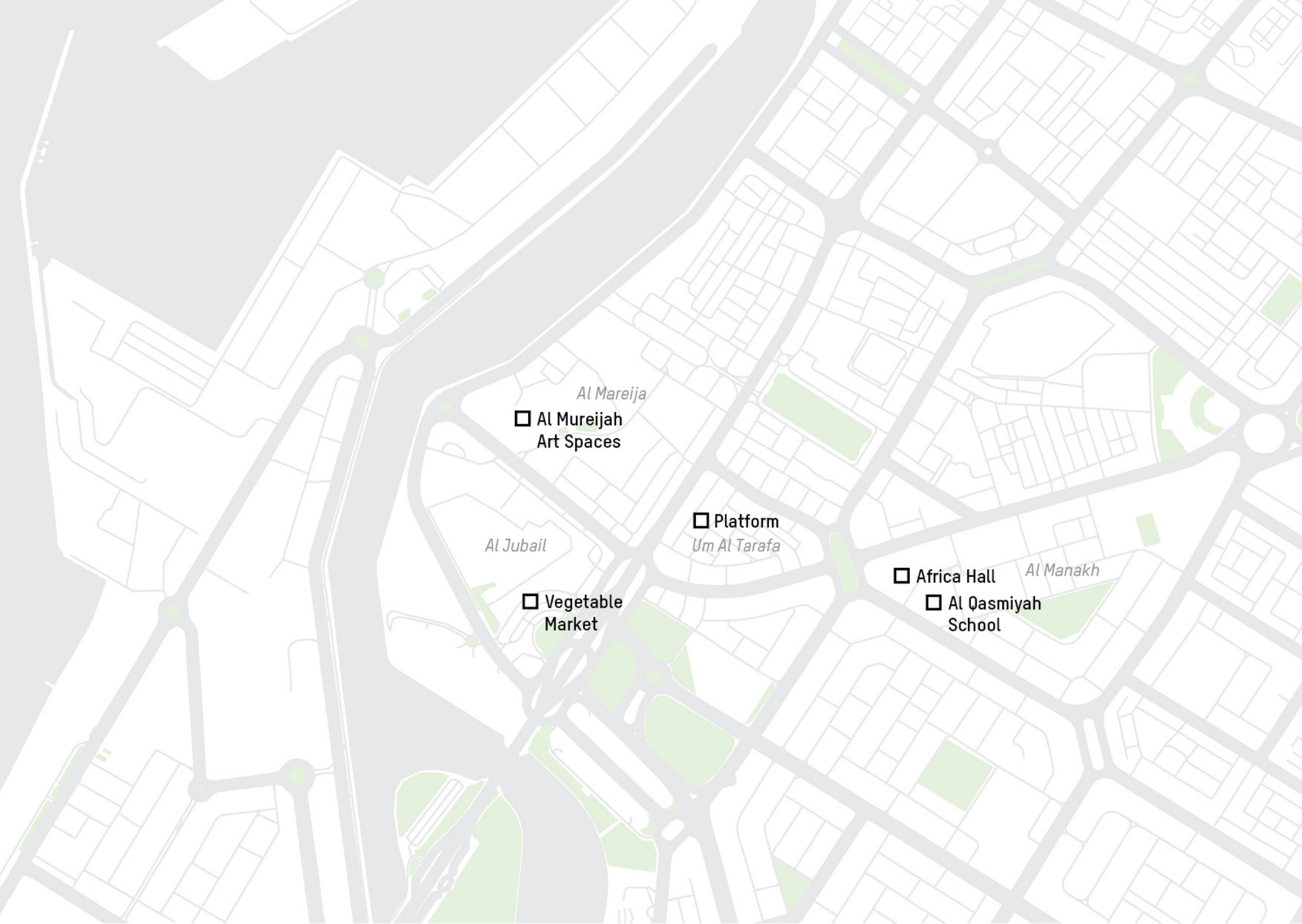
+971 6 566 8001 sharjaharchaeology.com

Mleiha Archaeological Centre

Located about 45 minutes from Sharjah City, the Mleiha Archaeological Centre offers is built around a preserved Umm Al Nar era tomb and concentrates on archaeological sites ranging from the Palaeolithic to the modern age. Excavations and discoveries made over the past 40 years in Mleiha and surrounding areas (including Al Thuqeibah, Jebel Faya, Al Madam and Jebel Buhais), particularly the important Faya North East findings, provide evidence that 'anatomically modern humans' were in the Mleiha area between 130,000 and 120,000 years ago and point to the spread of humanity from Africa across the Red Sea to the Gulf region. Interesting sites include Fossil Rock, Um an-Nar Tomb and the Mleiha Fort. An on-site restaurant serves food from 9:00 am to 9:00 pm.

Saturday – Wednesday: 9:00 am – 7:00 pm
Thursday – Friday: 9:00 am – 9:00 pm

Admission varies according to activities undertaken +971 6 883 1111
discovermleiha.ae



Al Mareija

□ Al Mureijah
Art Spaces

Al Jubail

□ Vegetable
Market

□ Platform
Um Al Tarafa

□ Africa Hall

Al Manakh

□ Al Qasmiyah
School

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For any further question please contact Sharjah Architecture Triennial Offices at info@sharjaharchitecturetriennial.org